

Question 28 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the need for integrating HRD practices with organisational strategy.

Introduction

Strategy is the organisation's chosen path to goals (which markets, what quality, what technology). HRD builds the people who walk that path. Integration is needed because unconnected HRD is busy but irrelevant.

Detailed points

- 1. Strategy is implemented by people.** A plan to digitalise branches fails if staff cannot use systems and supervisors cannot coach. Capability is strategy execution.
- 2. Avoid irrelevant training.** Without integration, popular courses eat budget while critical roles stay weak. Need is economic as well as logical.
- 3. Timing of talent.** Strategy may need 20 new team leaders in two years. Career and potential systems must start now. Integration is about time, not only topics.
- 4. Culture required by strategy.** Cost-leadership needs discipline and waste control; innovation needs psychological safety. HRD climate work must match the strategy type.
- 5. Priorities when money is limited.** Strategy tells what to develop first. Integration is a rationing tool.
- 6. Change readiness.** Strategic change creates fear. Integrated HRD (communication, training, counselling) reduces resistance. Need is change-management.
- 7. Credibility of HRD.** When HRD shows contribution to strategic outcomes, it is funded. Isolation makes HRD the first department cut.
- 8. Meaning for employees.** People learn better when they see why. Linking development to organisational goals increases engagement with HRD practices.

Conclusion. *Need = execution of strategy, relevance, timing, culture fit, resource priority, change, credibility, and employee meaning. Unintegrated HRD is activity without impact.*